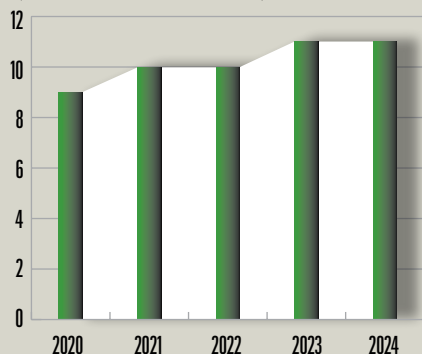
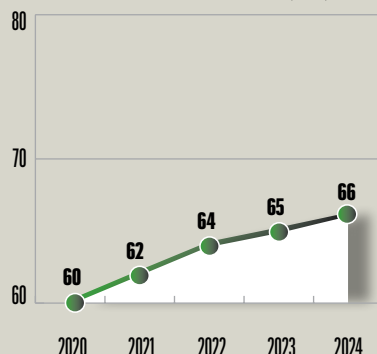


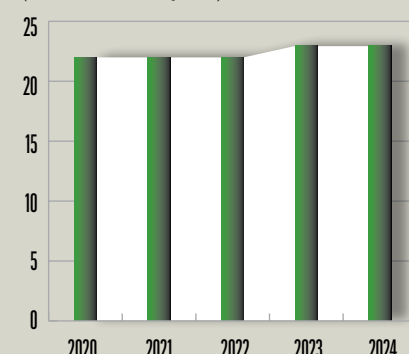
OBESITY PREVALENCE (CHILDREN, %)



SEMAGLUTIDE MARKET SHARE IN INDIA (%)



OBESITY PREVALENCE (ADULTS, %)



SOURCE NFHS, 2020; IMS HEALTH INDIA: MARKET INSIGHTS; NOVO NORDISK INDIA ANNUAL REPORT 2024

Bengaluru also handles market intelligence, digital content creation safety surveillance and regulatory documentation. The centre's contributions include support for medical strategy such as safety monitoring and medical writing. It is also involved in managing the global distribution by coordinating production schedules and aligning them with demand forecasts.

"India's market dynamics offer useful insights that may shape our global obesity strategy," says Dawber. "The country's demographic diversity, varying cultures, affordability and patient needs offer an opportunity to refine our education channels and partnerships. With our local collaborations and established ties with policymakers, India has the potential to influence future developments in obesity care."

DEMAND FOR GLP-1 DRUGS

Novo Nordisk reported strong growth in 2024 with revenue reaching DKK 290.4 billion (approximately \$42.1 billion), a 25% increase over the previous year. Net profit rose to DKK 100.9 billion (\$14.5 billion), up 20%, while operating profit was DKK 116.9 billion (\$17 billion). The trend continued in the first quarter of 2025, with revenue at DKK 78.09 billion (\$11.3 billion), up 19% year-on-year, and net profit at DKK 29.03 billion (\$4.2 billion), a 14% increase over Q1 2024. The weight-loss portfolio contributed significantly to this growth. Wegovy's sales reached DKK 58.2 billion (\$8 billion) in 2024, doubling from the previous year. However, the company continues to face

headwinds in the US market because of the presence of compounded alternatives, which the USFDA plans to phase out by May 2025. Novo Nordisk has adjusted its 2025 sales growth forecast to 13-21%. The US accounted for 57% revenue in Q1 2025.

India, where concerns around diabetes and obesity are growing, with over 200 million people estimated to be living with diabetes, offers a way out.

"Expanding middle class, urban living and evolving diets are contributing to both conditions," says Dr Rashmi Chaturvedi Upadhyay, Senior Pharma Consultant at Dialectica. "GLP-1 drugs are being seen as important because they address diabetes as well as obesity. As awareness improves and more affordable versions enter the market, these therapies are expected to play a larger role in diabetes care in the years ahead."

But access and pricing remain key challenges. Local pharmaceutical companies and public health programmes are working to improve availability. "The introduction of semaglutide in January 2022 marked a shift in India's obesity treatment market, which has grown several times over in the past five years," says Sheetal Sapale, VP, Commercial, Pharmarack.

"This expansion reflects not only increasing obesity rates but also a broader change in attitudes. More people are open to medical treatments, and the presence of international therapies like Wegovy and Ozempic has brought greater attention to this space," she says. **BT**

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